

Samsung's hotcakes

Samsung claims they have sold more than 5 million Galaxy S smartphones since its launch in June



More Air

Apple unveiled two new MacBook Air laptops in 11.6 and 13.3-inch screen sizes

Bazaar mini

MOTHERBOARD



ASUS Crosshair IV Formula

Price: ₹15,500



Biostar TA880GB+

Price: ₹5,000

CELLPHONE



Micromax E390

Price: ₹6,999

DIGITAL PHOTO FRAME



Sony DPF-X95

Price: ₹11,990

SPECIFICATIONS

Socket/Chipset AM3/AMD 890FX
Memory upto 16 GB DDR3 1333 MHz
PCIe x16/x4/PCI 2.2 3/2/1
SATA/e-SATA 7/2.

Socket/Chipset AM3/AMD 880G
Memory upto 16GB DDR3 1333 MHz
PCIe x16/x4/PCI 2.2 1/0/2
SATA/e-SATA 6 /0

Network CDMA
Screen 2.8-inch resistive
Battery 1000 mAh Li-ion
Camera 1.3 MP

Internal memory 2 GB
Resolution WVGA 800 x 600
Viewing area 177.85 x 111.1 mm
Image formats JPEG, RAW

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features 7.5
SupremeFX X-Fi 8-channel audio codec with Blu-Ray support. Onboard overclocking button.

Performance 6.5
Average performance on synthetic benchmarks. WinRAR performance rating was good. Crisis rating was above average.

Build quality 7.5
The board is neatly laid out with all solid state caps. It is built around an ATX form factor.

Value for money 6.0
Very good price point for its better than average performance.

Features 6.5
AM3 socket supports Phenom II CPUs. On-board ATI HD4250 graphics (DVI-D/HDMI output).

Performance 6.0
Benchmarks gave decent scores. Crisis gave a rating of 95 fps at high details for resolution of 1024x768 which is decent.

Build quality 6.0
Build quality is not up to the mark. Form factor is mATX. Light weight, poor quality plastic.

Value for money 7.0
At ₹5,000, it offers high end features for a low price.

Features 6.0
Resistive display. Missing volume up/down keys. Display quality is good and it has good battery life.

Performance 5.0
Touch interface is better than expected and it does not show too much lag. Poor audio quality on speakers and earphones.

Build quality 6.0
Earphones are not good quality but overall build-quality is slightly above average.

Value for money 5.0
Shortcomings in the audio and ergonomics departments.

Features 6.0
No additional features like alarm, or music playback. Many themes for slideshow.

Performance 7.5
Images are crisp and colours are rich. Does not take much time to turn on or access images from memory card.

Build quality 7.0
Sturdy build. Metal stand is of good quality. The remote provided is of mediocre quality.

Value for money 6.5
Too overpriced for just a photo frame. More features required.

WE SAY

7.0

We recommended this board only if you are looking to build a performance-oriented gaming rig in a budget of ₹70,000 - ₹80,000 combining any of the Phenom II X6 processors. the onboard core unlocking button gives an instant boost in performance which is a very good feature for gamers. RAID 0,1,5,10 configurations are supported. Great option if you want the Crosshair IV Extreme, but are following short on some cash.

ALSO SEE:
1) ECS P55H-AK
Digit October 2010

6.5

This board is available for ₹5,000 and is a very good option for a HTPC/SoHo under ₹35,000 but not viable for a hardcore gaming rig. It supports DirectX 10.1. Board can be overclocked in Windows as well using the bundled software from the CD. Upon overclocking, temperatures remain relatively stable. We managed to overclock the X6 1090T to 3.66 GHz.

ALSO SEE:
1) ECS Elitegroup A890GXM-A
Digit April 2010

5.5

A slight improvement on the audio and we would be able to justify its ₹6,999 price tag which seems to be pretty steep for a phone with such a small display. Battery life is good, and the interface is intuitive. Other than that, there is scope for improvement. Better phones at cheaper rates are available from other manufacturers.

ALSO SEE:
1) Micromax Qube
Digit October 2010
2) Wyncomm Y50
Digit September 2010
3) Intex IN 4410
Digit April 2010

6.5

No doubt Sony DPF-X95 is an expensive device and has a niche market. The quality of the product is extremely good. If you have a huge house and have everything but still you feel you are missing something, you might have your answer in Sony DPF-X95. Also it makes a great gift for that special someone. While it performs flawlessly, we would have liked a larger screen and support for other multimedia playback options especially when you're spending so much. There are cheaper alternatives if you are looking for a similarly sized digital photo frame.